

AIDEN — Laptop Setup & Run Guide

For team members receiving the project as a zip file

This project has two parts that run separately: a **backend** (Node.js) and a **frontend** (React). An **optional** third part (`vision_ai` , Python) adds server-side object/currency/text detection but is not required for the app to run.

1. What must be installed on the laptop first

Software	Version	Why
Node.js (includes npm)	18 or newer (20 LTS recommended)	Runs both backend and frontend
A modern browser	Chrome or Edge, latest	Camera/mic + on-device AI features need a recent browser
Python (<i>optional</i>)	3.10 - 3.12	Only needed for the optional <code>vision_ai</code> server

Download Node.js from nodejs.org — pick the LTS installer for Windows/Mac and run it with default settings. This also installs npm automatically. After installing, **close and reopen** the terminal/PowerShell window.

Verify the install

```
node -v
npm -v
```

Both commands should print a version number with no errors. If you see an error like `npm-prefix.js not found` , Node.js was installed incorrectly or a broken older copy is still on the PATH — uninstall Node completely and reinstall fresh from nodejs.org.

2. Unzip the project

Extract the zip file anywhere convenient, e.g. `Documents\AIDEN` . You should see two main folders: `backend/` and `frontend/` .

3. Run the Backend

- 1 Open a terminal and go into the backend folder:

```
cd path\to\AIDEN\backend
```

- 2 Copy the example environment file and fill in real values:

```
copy .env.example .env
```

Open the new `.env` file in any text editor and set:

- `JWT_SECRET` — any random long string (used to sign login tokens)
- `OPENROUTER_API_KEY` — needed for the AIDEN Assistant chatbot to answer online; if left as the placeholder, the assistant still works using its offline fallback

- 3 Install dependencies and start the server:

```
npm install
npm run dev
```

You should see `AIDEN backend listening on :4000` . Leave this terminal window open — closing it stops the backend.

4. Run the Frontend

1 Open a **second, separate** terminal window (keep the backend one running) and go into the frontend folder:

```
cd path\to\AIDEN\frontend
```

2 Install dependencies and start it:

```
npm install
npm run dev
```

It will print a local address, usually:

```
Local: http://localhost:5173/
```

3 Open that address in Chrome or Edge. Sign up for a new account on the login screen to start using the app.

5. Optional — the Python Vision AI server

Only needed if you want server-side object/currency/text detection instead of the built-in browser-based detection (which already works without this). Skip this section if you just want the app running.

```
cd path\to\AIDEN\backend
pip install -r vision_ai\requirements.txt
uvicorn vision_ai.server:app --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8001
```

The first run downloads some pretrained models automatically (needs internet, only happens once).

6. Everyday use after the first setup

You only need to repeat `npm install` if dependencies changed. Normally, every time you want to run the app:

```
Terminal 1: cd backend && npm run dev
Terminal 2: cd frontend && npm run dev
```

Then open `http://localhost:5173` in the browser.

7. Common problems

Problem	Fix
<code>vite: not found</code> or similar on <code>npm run dev</code>	Run <code>npm install</code> in that folder first — dependencies weren't installed yet.
Camera/mic says "already in use"	Close other tabs/apps using the camera, or fully refresh the browser tab.
Camera/mic permission errors	Click the camera icon in the browser's address bar and allow access, then retry. Camera/mic only work on <code>http://localhost</code> or a real HTTPS site — not plain HTTP.
No voice / silent app	Tap anywhere on the page once — most browsers block the very first automatic voice attempt until there's been a real click.
Assistant chatbot gives generic replies only	Add a real <code>OPENROUTER_API_KEY</code> in backend/.env — otherwise it uses its offline fallback replies.
Backend says port 4000 already in use	Another program (or a previous copy of the backend) is already running on that port — close it, or change <code>PORT</code> in <code>.env</code> .

8. Quick checklist before asking for help

- ☐ Node.js installed and `node -v` works
- ☐ Backend terminal shows "AIDEN backend listening on :4000" with no red errors

- ☐ Frontend terminal shows a working `localhost:5173` [link](#)
- ☐ Browser is Chrome or Edge, latest version
- ☐ `backend/.env` exists (copied from `.env.example`)

If something still doesn't work after these steps, copy the exact error text from the terminal or browser console and send it along — that's the fastest way to get it fixed.